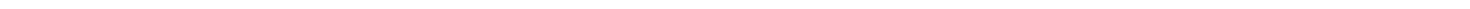


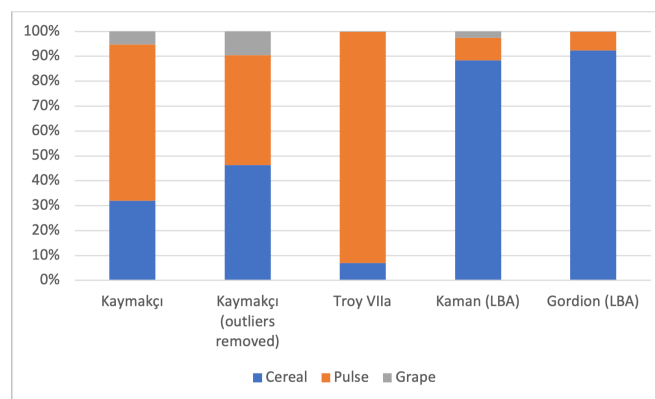
Interpretation



Interpretation

One of the central concerns of the Kaymakçı project was to determine whether the inhabitants were politically or economically affiliated with the Hittite or Mycenaean kingdoms, or whether Kaymakçı was independent, perhaps the capital of a smaller kingdom known in Hittite records as the “Seha River Lands,” which is believed by contemporary scholars to lie in this area of western Turkey. While excavations at Kaymakçı continue, evidence to date suggests that the third hypothesis is correct: while inhabitants of Kaymakçı had access to artifacts from both the Mycenaean and Hittite worlds, including imported beads, chisels, and lead weights, they also continued local traditions by making pottery in a traditional local style.

Food remains from Kaymakçı show a similar pattern: the use of foods similar to sites on the Aegean (such as Troy) and those squarely under Hittite control in central Turkey (e.g., Kaman and Gordion). While Aegean sites tend to have large quantities of pulses (edible legumes, such as lentil, pea, and chickpea), Hittite sites in central Turkey primarily relied instead on cereals (various types of wheat and barley). As shown in the graph below, Kaymakçı falls in between these two extremes, while also including relatively large quantities of grape seeds, possibly reflecting local wine production.



Botanical results from Kaymakçı compared to those of an Aegean site (Troy) and two Hittite-controlled sites (Kaman and Gordion).

Source: [American Journal of Archaeology](https://ajaonline.org/field-report/3764/)

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Kaymakçı is an excellent example of how archaeologists go about finding and planning the excavation of a site, and also how research questions for the project are answered through the study of ancient food remains. Kaymakçı also demonstrates the multi-disciplinary nature of archaeological projects, with specialists in the study of seeds, bones, and pots coming together with scholars who use photogrammetry, drone imagery, high-resolution GPS, and geophysics in survey and excavation.